Arusyak Aleksanyan, PhD

Associate Professor · Head of the Research Unit · Political Scientist

Center for European Studies, Yerevan State University, Yerevan, Armenia
Email: arusyak.aleksanyan@ysu.am · ORCID: 0000-0002-1729-1532
LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/arusyak-aleksanyan · Website: a-aleksanyan.github.io

PROFILE

Political scientist and Associate Professor specialising in democratization, political stability, policy analysis, European affairs, research methodology, parliamentary development, public opinion research, institutional capacity assessment and composite index development. Author of around 70 scientific articles, chapters, books and research works.

Developer of the **Stability Index of Political System (SIPS)** and the **Index of Democracy Level (IDL)**, applied to the comparative scaling and ranking of countries; author of the **Index of Parliament Perception (IPP)**, developed within the UNDP project "Modern Parliament for a Modern Armenia"; and co-author of the **Education Preparedness Index in COVID-19 (EPIC)**.

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Head of the Research Unit; Lecturer **2012 – present**
Center for European Studies, Yerevan State University

Research areas: democratization, policy analysis, research methods, political stability, European affairs.

- Lead and implement large-scale interdisciplinary research projects.
- Develop course curricula and teaching materials; deliver lectures and seminars; conduct examinations and assessments.
- Supervise master's theses.

Lecturer **2010 – present**
International Scientific-Educational Center, National Academy of Sciences of the Republic of Armenia

Subject areas: political technologies, research methods.

- Develop course curricula; deliver lectures and seminars, including for postgraduate students.
- Conduct examinations and assessments; supervise master's theses.

Vice Chair, Research Ethics Committee **2024 – present**
Yerevan State University

- Evaluate research proposals to ensure that ethical standards are met, particularly regarding the rights, safety, dignity and well-being of participants.
- Advise researchers on ethical good practice and emerging ethical issues in research.

TEACHING AND SUPERVISION

Courses taught: Research Methodology; Political Analysis and Forecasting.

Earlier subject areas: political technologies; research methods.

Supervision: master's theses at Yerevan State University and at the International Scientific-Educational Center of NAS RA; teaching includes postgraduate students.

RESEARCH PROJECTS AND CONSULTANCIES

National Consultant on GESI-Responsive Electoral Data Systems and Statistics **09/2026 – 11/2026**
UNDP Armenia – ARTEMIS project: "Advancing Reforms for Transparent and Inclusive Management of Electoral Systems in Armenia"

- Assess the Central Electoral Commission's electoral datasets, data-management systems and reporting practices, identifying gaps in data quality, disaggregation and institutional capacity.
- Develop a gender equality and social inclusion (GESI)-responsive framework for electoral data collection, analysis and reporting, with attention to women, persons with disabilities and under-represented groups.

- Conduct stakeholder consultations and assess opportunities for cooperation with public institutions and civil society organisations.
- Develop training materials and provide practical guidance to CEC staff on electoral statistics, data analysis, visualisation and reporting.

National Expert on Survey Design and Analysis for Parliamentary Administrative Capacity **02/2026 – 04/2026**
UNDP Armenia – MAP 2.0 / FORSETI project

- Designed and adapted an Administrative Capacity Assessment Survey for Members of Parliament, aligned with the IPU Indicators and the Armenian parliamentary context.
- Developed the questionnaire, scoring methodology, guidance notes and aggregation logic.
- Implemented the MP survey in coordination with UNDP and National Assembly focal points, ensuring confidentiality and data quality.
- Analysed the survey data, integrated the findings with the Institutional Capacity Index (ICI) and Public Opinion Poll methodology, and prepared an analytical report with recommendations.

YSU Partner Team Lead, REDEMOS project (Horizon Europe) **01/2023 – 01/2026**
HORIZON-CL2-2021-DEMOCRACY-01-04: "REconfiguring EU DEMOcracy Support? Towards a Sustained Demos in the EU's Eastern Neighbourhood"

- Led the research activities of Work Package 2.
- Organised and implemented Yerevan State University's contributions across the project's work packages.

Local Consultant for Parliamentary Data Analysis and Visualization **07/2025 – 12/2025**
UNDP Armenia – "Modern Parliament for a Modern Armenia" (MAP) project

- Developed parliamentary indicator baskets and a unified methodology for data collection, validation and aggregation.
- Designed and implemented an internal aggregation system and integrated departmental data into the "Parliament in Figures" webpage.
- Trained and mentored National Assembly staff on data entry, validation, interpretation and maintenance of the statistical tool.
- Reviewed and upgraded the MAP 2.0 Public Opinion Poll questionnaire in line with updated indicators and project priorities.

National Senior Expert on Statistics and Data Collation for Index Development **07/2022 – 01/2023**
UNDP Armenia – "Modern Parliament for a Modern Armenia" (MAP) project

- Reviewed the project's public opinion poll methodology and questionnaire and provided methodological guidance.
- Developed the structure and calculation methodology of a new index to feed into periodic public opinion polls, crowdsourcing, focus groups and other surveys.
- Applied the index, calculated the results and prepared the report on the Index of Parliament Perception in Armenia.

Head of Research **08/2020 – 07/2021**
"Enabling Learning to Happen for All Children in Emergency Crisis", supported by the Global Campus of Human Rights and the Right Livelihood Award Foundation; implemented by Global Campus Caucasus at the Center for European Studies, YSU

- Developed the research roadmap and methodological approach, and planned and coordinated expert research assignments.
- Coordinated the development of a new index measuring education system preparedness in emergency crises (EPIC).
- Supervised the research team, monitored progress and ensured that deliverables met quality and scientific standards.

Co-editor, Editorial Committee **2019**
Global Campus Human Rights Journal, Vol. 3, No. 1 (2019), Venice, Italy – hdl.handle.net/20.500.11825/1001

- Handled submissions, managed content areas and deadlines, and reviewed and edited articles.

Academic Coordinator **02/2018 – 07/2018**

"The Influence of Diaspora on Democracy-Building Processes: Behavioural Diversity", Global Campus Classroom Research 2018, European Inter-University Centre for Human Rights and Democratisation

- Proposed the research methodology, monitored the regional papers and produced a regional research paper.
- Ensured that the papers met the academic standards required for publication in the Global Campus Human Rights Journal.

EARLIER PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Head of the Information Analysis and Program Development Department **2009 – 2011**

"Center for Organizing Youth Activities" SNCO, Ministry of Sport and Youth Affairs of the Republic of Armenia

- Planned the development of youth structures, particularly in the regions (marzes) of Armenia; gathered and analysed information for youth projects.
- Assessed project proposals, monitored implementation and reviewed project reports; organised trainings and seminars.
- Maintained relations with government bodies, international organisations and NGOs, and managed the organisation's website.

External Relations Officer **2005 – 2008**

Foundation for Applied Research and Agribusiness (FARA), USDA-supported

- Planned and implemented information and communication strategies; prepared annual reports, booklets, newsletters and website content.
- Responded to public and media enquiries; maintained relations with NGOs, government and international organisations; monitored project reports.

EDUCATION AND ACADEMIC TITLES

Associate Professor (academic title), Political Science **2022**

PhD in Political Science **2009**

Institute of Philosophy, Sociology and Law, National Academy of Sciences of the Republic of Armenia

Dissertation: *Application of Technologies for the Analysis of Political Situations in the Republic of Armenia*

Postgraduate studies, Political Science **2004 – 2009**

Department of Political Science, Faculty of International Relations, Yerevan State University

MA in Political Science (with honours) **2001 – 2003**

Department of Political Science, Faculty of International Relations, Yerevan State University

BA in Political Science (with honours) **1997 – 2001**

Department of Political Science, Faculty of International Relations, Yerevan State University

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Full list: orcid.org/0000-0002-1729-1532 and a-aleksanyan.github.io/#publications

Aleksanyan, A. [Ashot], **Aleksanyan, A. [Arusyak]**, & Gbadebo, A. D. (2026). Strategic diversification of China's foreign policy in Africa: The Belt and Road Initiative and the transformation of China's public diplomacy in Nigeria. *Journal of Political Science: Bulletin of Yerevan University*, *5*(1(13)), 95–118.

Chappell, L., **Aleksanyan, A.**, Exadaktylos, T., & Richter, M. M. (2026). *Stocktaking of EU democracy support towards the eastern neighbourhood*. Zenodo. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.19219915

Raik, K., Gretskiy, I., Fedosiuk, T., Metreveli, E., Gogolashvili, K., **Aleksanyan, A.**, & Maltsev, A. (2026). *Third-country competition and EU democracy support in the Eastern Neighbourhood*. Zenodo. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.18267307

Aleksanyan, A., Manukyan, N., Mkrtchyan, N., Rebilas, R., & Vardanyan, N. (2025). Extracurricular activities in higher education: Challenges, economic implications, and practices in Armenia and the EU. *Forum Scientiae Oeconomia*, *13*(2), 52–75. https://doi.org/10.23762/FSO_VOL13_NO2_3

Aleksanyan, A. (2025). Armenia: Economy. In Europa Publications (Ed.), *Eastern Europe, Russia and Central Asia 2026*. Routledge.

Aleksanyan, A. (Ed.). (2024). *Resilient political systems at the crossroads of hybrid wars and peace (Armenia, Georgia, Azerbaijan, Iran, Turkey, Russia, and Ukraine)*. YSU Press. https://doi.org/10.46991/YSUPH/9785808426931

Aleksanyan, A., & Aleksanyan, A. (2024). Resilience of civiliarchic democracy in the face of challenges and gaps in European integration: The political dimension of the Index of Civiliarchy. *Journal of Political Science: Bulletin of Yerevan University, 3*(3(9)), 97–138. https://doi.org/10.46991/JOPS/2024.3.9.097

Aleksanyan, A., Serobyan, A., Chappell, L., Exadaktylos, T., Gevorgyan, K., & Richter, M. M. (2024). *EU and EU member states' democracy support actions (2010–2022): REDEMOS dataset 2.5* [Data set]. Zenodo. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.13145726

Aleksanyan, A., & Muradyan, M. (Eds.). (2023). *Education Preparedness Index in COVID-19 (EPIC): Methodology and research*. YSU Press. https://doi.org/10.46991/YSUPH/9785808425910

Aleksanyan, A., & Aleksanyan, A. (2021). *Political stability challenges in the EEU countries: Political factors index*. YSU Press. https://doi.org/10.46991/YSUPH/9785808425200

Aleksanyan, A., Bejanyan, V., Dodon, C., Maksimenko, K., & Simonian, A. (2019). Diaspora and democratisation: Diversity of impact in Eastern Partnership countries. *Global Campus Human Rights Journal, 3*(1), 86–112. https://hdl.handle.net/20.500.11825/993

Aleksanyan, A. (Ed.). (2015). *Comparative analysis of the Index of Democracy Level: Armenia, Georgia, Azerbaijan, Russia, Belarus, Kazakhstan, Ukraine and Moldova*. YSU Press.

Aleksanyan, A. (Ed.). (2013). *The political stability index of the South Caucasus, EurAsEC and EU member states: In-country and cross-country analysis*. Yerevan University Press.

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Methods: research design; survey and questionnaire design; composite index construction (normalisation, weighting, aggregation); quantitative data analysis; public opinion polling; institutional capacity assessment; research ethics review.

Software: SPSS, R, Microsoft Office.

Languages: Armenian (native), English, Russian.